

# MAKING A MARK

**PHARMA MAJOR GLENMARK IS STRATEGICALLY PLOTTING ITS WAY UP, ALL BY SHIFTING ITS FOCUS TO BRANDED AND SPECIALITY MEDICINE AND ENSURING IT GETS ITS R&D RIGHT**

**BY NEETU CHANDRA SHARMA**

**PHOTO BY MILIND SHELTE**

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**UMBAI'S AFTERNOON SUN** has bathed Glenmark House in Andheri East in a warm glow as Glenn Saldanha, Chairman and Managing Director of Glenmark Pharmaceuticals Ltd, strides into a boardroom for an interview. Saldanha, who has led Glenmark for nearly 30 years, the last 12 as CMD, has had enough of the volatile business of making APIs or active pharmaceutical ingredients, taking debt for working capital and depending on best-selling brands with margins measured in teaspoons.

Debt is now a bad word in Glenmark House. Saldanha's buzzwords now are complex generics and speciality drugs (read: fat margins). Glenmark jettisoned its ₹4,600-crore debt in the second quarter of 2024 by selling a 75% stake in its API business to Nirma Ltd on September 21, 2023, for around ₹5,651 crore. It aims to be debt-free by 2026.

Its success with Ryaltris, a nasal spray that is a fixed-dose combination of an anti-allergic and a steroid, launched in Q1 of 2021-22, has cleared